

Such mail arriving frequently in your inbox can be easily detected by spam filters. Email bombing is commonly carried out using botnets (private internet connected computers whose security has been compromised by malware and under the attacker's control) as a DDoS attack. This type of attack is more difficult to control due to multiple source addresses and the bots which are programmed to send different messages to defeat spam filters.

"Spamming" is a variant of email bombing. Here unsolicited bulk messages are sent to a large number of users, indiscriminately. Opening links given in spam mails may lead you to phishing web sites hosting malware. Spam mail may also have infected files as attachments. Email spamming worsens when the recipient replies to the email causing all the original addressees to receive the reply. Spammers collect email addresses from customer lists, newsgroups, chat-rooms, web sites and viruses which harvest users' address books, and sell them to other spammers as well. A large amount of spam is sent to invalid email addresses.



Email filters cleaning out spam mail

Sending spam violates the acceptable use policy (AUP) of almost all internet service providers. If your system suddenly becomes sluggish (email loads slowly or doesn't appear to be sent or received), the reason may be that your mailer is processing a large number of messages. Unfortunately, at this time, there's no way to completely prevent email bombing and spam mails as it's impossible to predict the origin of the next attack. However, what you can do is identify the source of the spam mails and have your router configured to block any incoming packets from that address.

7. Web jacking

Web jacking derives its name from "hijacking". Here, the hacker takes control of a web site fraudulently. He may change the content of the original site or even redirect the user to another fake similar looking page controlled by him. The owner of the web site has no more control and the attacker may use the web site for his own selfish interests. Cases have been reported where the attacker has asked for ransom, and even posted obscene material on the site.

The web jacking method attack may be used to create a clone of the web site, and present the victim with the new link saying that the site has moved.